

Problem #5: Washo

Solution:

Assignment 1: Translate the following sentences into English. If there are multiple translations possible, give all of them.

a. *da'mo'mo' basa' umsilige basa'i*

The woman wrote the book that she gave to you.

b. *telihu basa' disilisge digyi*

I saw the book that the man gave to me.

c. *da'mo'mo' basa' disilisge dipigelyayi*

I returned to the woman the book she gave to me.

AND

The woman returned to me the book that I gave to her.

Assignment 2: Translate the following sentences into Washo.

a. The man gave to me the book that I returned to him.

telihu basa' dipigelyayisge disili

b. You saw the book that you gave the woman.

da'mo'mo' basa' umsilige umgyi

Assignment 3:

1. Verbr roots: *basa'* (write), *sil* (give), *gy* (see), *pigelyay* (return)
Note: *basa'i*, *sili*, *gyi*, *pigelyayi* are also valid answers.
Nouns: *telihu* (man), *da'mo'mo'* (woman), *basa'* (book)
2. Suffixes:
-i : past tense
-ge : found on verbs of relative (or any other name for it) clauses
-s- : found on verbs of relative clauses before -ge, if the subject of the relative clause is different from the subject of the matrix/main clause
Prefixes:
di- : first person argument (subject and indirect object)
um- : second person argument (subject and indirect object)
3. **Note:** We will be using the following terminology: S for subjects, O for objects and R for recipients, rel for relative clauses and mat for matrix clauses. Since the object of matrix and relative clauses is same in all the sentences ("book"), I will simply refer to it as O. Thus, we have 5 arguments, S-rel, S-mat, O, R-rel and R-mat, and 2 verbs, V-rel and V-mat, in each sentence.

The underlying order is: S-rel R-rel O V-rel S/R-mat* V-mat

***Note:** Any relative ordering between S-mat and R-mat is acceptable.

If R-mat or S-mat is an argument in the relative clause (either R-rel or S-rel), then it is omitted i.e. the same argument is not repeated twice.

Moreover, if any of these arguments are 1st person or 2nd person, then that argument is omitted, and it is only marked as a prefix on the respective verb.

Of course, if the verb has no recipient (write/see), then the recipient argument is omitted.